



How to perform the option 7 "Install new software first" from the ONTAP boot menu

https://kb.netapp.com/on-prem/ontap/Ontap_OS/OS-KBs/How_to_perform_the_option_7_Install_new_...

Updated: Thu, 09 Jul 2026 17:47:49 GMT

Applies to

ONTAP 9

Description

This article describes the method of using the "(7) Install new software first." ONTAP boot menu to download and install a new ONTAP image to the boot device.

Procedure

WARNING

- This process requires that the web server **MUST** be reachable by ICMP (ping), as the ONTAP code requires this network visibility. Check your firewall or network for any entries that deny ICMP (ping) packets if your attempts to reach the web server fails.
- This article covers boot menu options only. For a complete process follow [How to decommission or repurpose an HA Pair with ONTAP 9](#).
- If a web server is not available, consider [How to use the boot_recovery LOADER command for installing ONTAP for initial setup of a system](#).

1. [Netboot the node](#) using the ONTAP image desired to be installed on the boot device. This requirement ensures both partitions on the boot device are updated with the correct ONTAP image.
2. After the netboot completes at the boot menu, select option: (7) `Install new software first` from the menu.

```
(1) Normal Boot.
(2) Boot without /etc/rc.
(3) Change password.
(4) Clean configuration and initialize all disks.
(5) Maintenance mode boot.
(6) Update flash from backup config.
(7) Install new software first.
(8) Reboot node.
(9) Configure Advanced Drive Partitioning.
(10) Set Onboard Key Manager recovery secrets.
(11) Configure node for external key management.
Selection (1-11)? 7
```

3. When prompted enter **y** when warned that this process replaces the existing ONTAP software with new software.

```
This procedure will replace existing Data ONTAP software with new
software.
Do you want to continue? {y|n} y
```

4. Enter the same URL used in the netboot command.

```
What is the URL for the package? http://192.168.0.2/NetApp/
9111P6_q_image.tgz
```

What is the user name on "192.168.0.2", if any?

5. Decide whether or not to restore the 'varfs' backup configuration to the boot device.

- a. Enter **y** if the cluster is currently operational and you wish restore the node configuration and the HA partner node is up.
- b. Enter **n** if this is a repurposed system with no data currently being served and the HA partner node is down.

```
*****
*                               *
*       Restore Backup Configuration       *
* This procedure only applies to storage controllers that *
* are configured as an HA pair.           *
*                                         *
* Choose Yes to restore the 'varfs' backup configuration *
* from a TFTP server. Refer to the Boot Device Replacement *
* guide for more details.                 *
* Choose No to skip the back up recovery and return to the *
* boot menu.                             *
*****
```

Do you want to restore the backup configuration now? {y|n}

6. Reboot the node when prompted.

The node must be rebooted to start using the newly installed software. Do you want to reboot now? {y/n} y

7. If the cluster is currently operational and the HA partner was down preventing restoring the backup, you will need to do an option 6 ((6) Update flash from backup config.) at the subsequent reboot

Additional Information

additionalInformation_text